

What Are Some Effective Abstract Reasoning Questions for MBA CET 2026 Preparation?

Abstract Reasoning is a core part of the MBA CET pattern, accounting for *25 questions out of the total 200*. This section tests your ability to spot patterns, relationships, and logical progressions in shapes and figures—a skill that doesn't rely on words or numbers but purely on visual and analytical thinking.

What Is Abstract Reasoning in MBA CET?

Abstract Reasoning is the ability to interpret and analyse visual information and problem-solve using patterns and logic rather than language or numbers.

In the MBA CET context, this section typically assesses your capacity to:

- Recognise sequences and progressions in shapes or figures.
- Identify similarities, differences, and relationships.
- Make logical deductions based solely on visual clues.

A typical question might show a sequence where figures rotate, change orientation, or transform in other consistent ways. Your objective is to deduce what comes next or which option doesn't fit.

In this blog, We will cover the concepts and techniques that students need to be aware of while preparing for the abstract reasoning section of the CET. The Abstract reasoning or the visual reasoning section is of 25 marks out of 200 and is one of the easier sections of the test.

Some advantages of this section:

- All the students start with the same information/knowledge about the question unlike Quant or Verbal where you can't answer a question if you don't know a particular formula or a grammar rule.
- Most of the times, the answer can be obtained by concentrating on a few elements of the image and through option elimination.
- Even with limited exposure, students can potentially hit very good score and accuracy in this section.

Some disadvantages of this section:

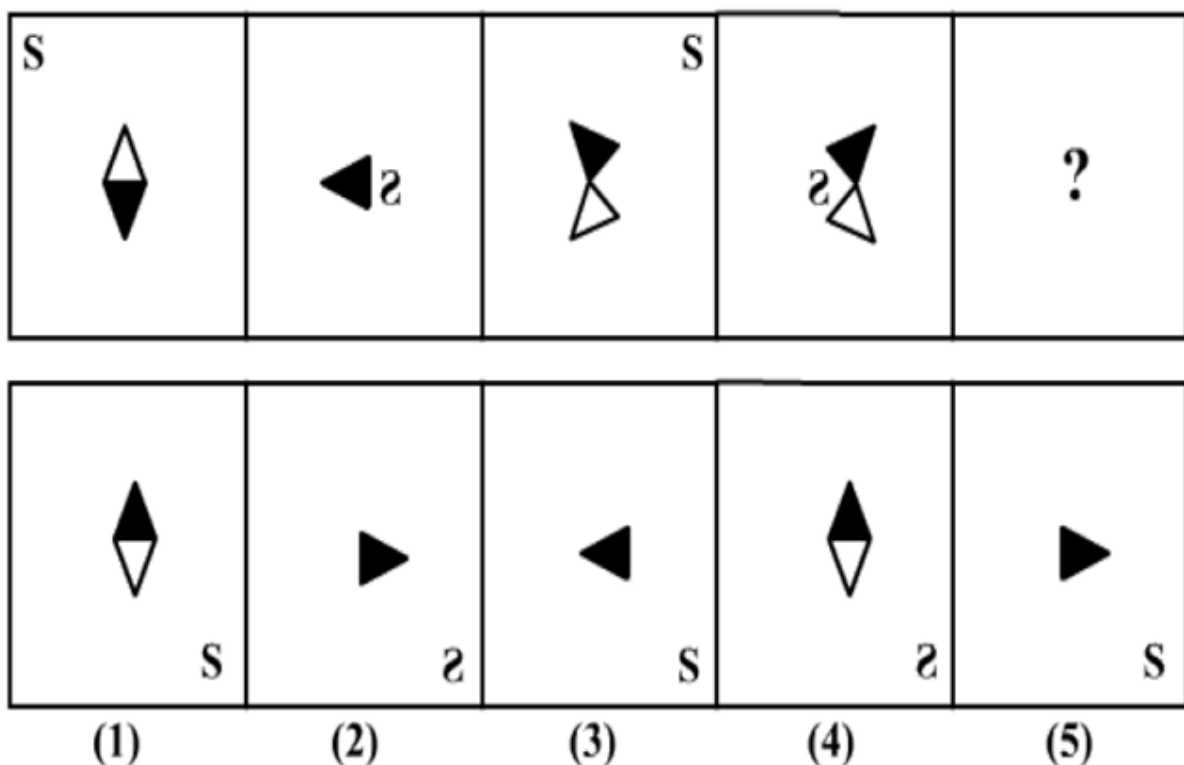
- Certain question types are extremely time consuming (for example, six faces of the cube are presented and one is supposed to figure out which of the options can be correctly constructed.
- One might think in a particular direction for a long time and check for individual objects within a figure, but the logic is something entirely different or located in the objects that you haven't checked yet
- For some students, visualizing figures or rotations in a 2-d setting is difficult and irritating.

With these in mind, let's understand what kind of logic(s) do students typically come across in these questions.

1. Increase / decrease in number of entities
2. Rotation (clockwise/ anticlockwise)
3. Rotation of objects at specific positions and at specific angles
4. Shaded / non-shaded regions / no. of fragments
5. Positional changes
6. Change in size of objects
7. Mirror image / water image / symmetry
8. Directional changes (North-South-East-West)
9. Addition / Deletion from a specific position or of a specific entity
10. Alternate figures have the same logic
11. Different figures or numbers used as objects (counting related)
12. Flipping of objects
13. Removal and Replacement from a source to a destination

Though this list is not exhaustive, it's fairly indicative of what can be asked and covers nearly 80-90% of the questions. The specific question types on cubes, paper folding and cutting, and constructing figures from components or deconstructing figures into components have specific approaches and are different from the list mentioned above which largely focuses on series, odd man out, analogy, and similar/dissimilar pair questions.

Let's understand the process to reach the answer in a quick manner. Consider the following **series** based question.



The first thing that one can spot here is the orientation of S. In alternate figures, S is correctly written. In the place of question mark, we should have S in the correct form. That leaves us with option 1/3/5. If I focus on the shaded triangle now, the movement is clock-

wise 90-45-90 which should be 45 in the next. That gives us a right pointing triangle which is option 5. At this stage, it would be wise to go with option 5 and not think of what's happening to the other triangle.

We'll look at one more **series** question. Try this:

# □ △	■ ★ θ	# Σ △	?	# Σ S
● =	= ●	● =		@ =
θ ★ ■	△ Σ #	θ ★ ○		θ ★ ○

△ ★ θ	○ ★ θ	@ ★ θ	@ ★ θ	○ ★ θ
= ●	= ●	= ●	=	= @
○ Σ #	△ Σ #	△ Σ #	△ Σ #	△ Σ #

(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

If I focus on the two central objects, what we see is = = , black circle-black circle, which should be followed by = = , and @ post that to match with the next @ in sequence. That's happening in only one option which leads you to the answer in the shortest possible time. ***The rest of the objects are of no concern once you're able to establish a fairly convincing logic.***

Moving on to the next example. Consider this **odd figure** question:

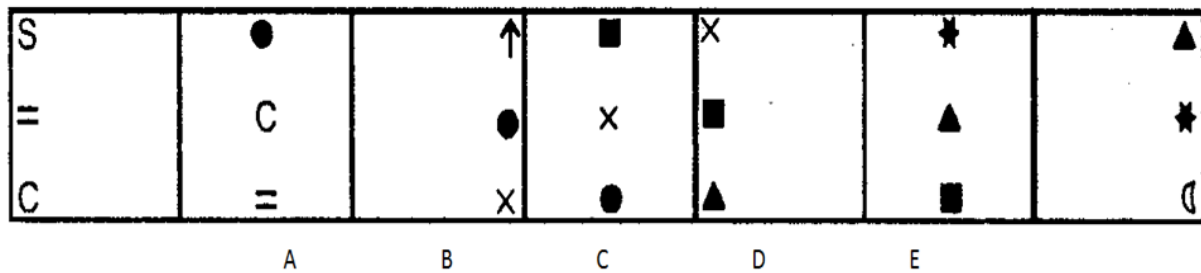
~	○	L	✂	E	↔	Σ	«	↑	N	Σ
R	1	┐	θ	W	:-	Σ	U	%	2	2
↑	Я	6	┐	:-	W	U	Σ	S	2	W
○	~	✂	┐	↔	E	↑	«	2	W	W

(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

In this question, picking up an element and identifying the change is the best approach. In every figure, we have mirror images of the objects on the left side. In case of option 4, instead of getting a mirror image of U, we have a water image. Clearly, that's the odd figure from the given set.

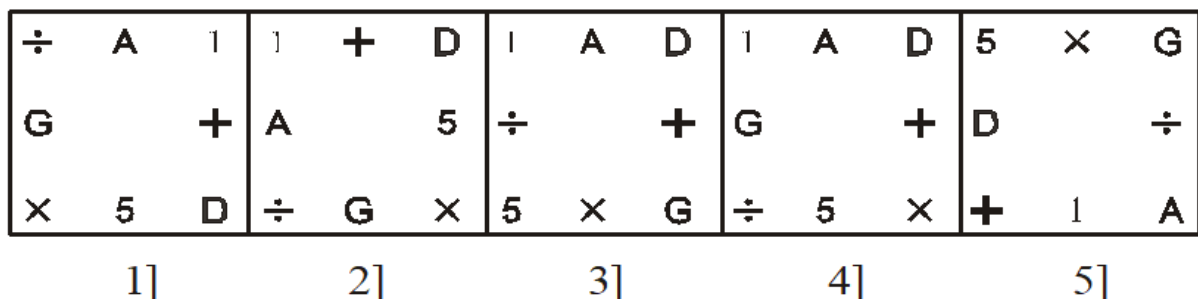
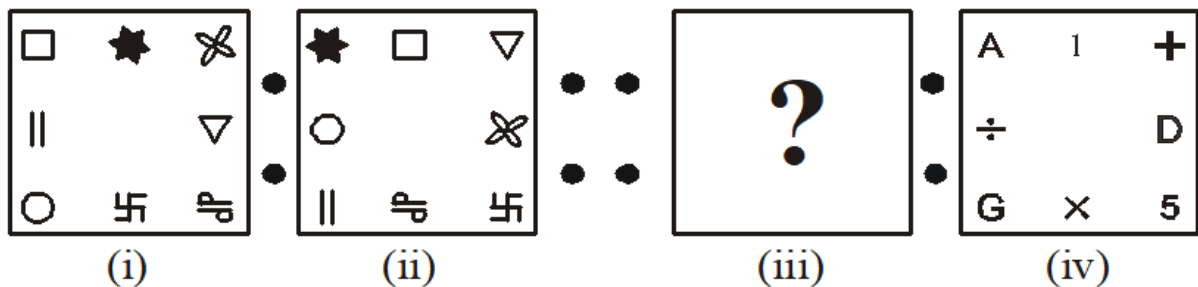
In case of **odd in series** type, the general tendency is to assume the first and the last option to be correct as they're right next to or prior to the correct figures presented in the question.

However, there is a fair chance that option 1 or option 5 is the answer. Let's look at a question.



In this case, from problem figure to option A, we find cross-wise movement of = and C. This happens in option B and C, and D and E as well. Between option A and B, we have two new elements. Between B and C, we have one new element. Between C and D, we have one new element. So there is something fishy about movement from A to B. As Problem figure and A have one new element, A is the correct figure. Changing figure B here will fix this series, making B the odd figure in series.

Let's look at a question based on **analogy**.



In this case, as we need to find the third image, I will try to establish the logic between second and the first figure and then apply it on the fourth figure to get the third. I see the Swastika sign interchanging its position with the next object. The same thing will happen to X and 5, giving us 5 and X as the pattern in the final answer. Hence, option 4 is the right answer.

It is possible for two students to arrive at the same answer in two or more different ways in these kind of questions. The idea is to find the logic as early as possible and extend it to the images in the question and look for patterns or inconsistencies.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

Avoid these pitfalls during preparation and in the actual exam:

- **Overthinking:** Sometimes the rule is simple. Don't complicate things unnecessarily.

- **Skipping Elements:** Check size, orientation, count, and position—not just one attribute.
 - **Ignoring Speed Practice:** Given time constraints, you must practice timing as much as accuracy.
-

How to Practice Abstract Reasoning Effectively

Follow a structured practice plan for better results:

Start With Basics

Start with simpler problems to build pattern-recognition confidence.

Use Timed Sessions

Simulate real exam conditions—speed matters as much as correctness.

Take Mock Tests

Regular full-length mock tests help track improvement and expose weaknesses early.

Conclusion

The **Abstract Reasoning** section in MBA CET is a scoring opportunity for aspirants who develop strong pattern recognition, logical deduction, and time management. With consistent practice and understanding of the common question types—patterns, analogies, classification, and matrix problems—you can significantly raise your score in this section. Commit to daily practice, review your mistakes, and work on time efficiency to excel in Abstract Reasoning for **MBA CET 2026**.